The Nostalgia Kit

Pop Culture & Daily Life: 1950s – 1980s

INSIDE THIS KIT

- Conversation Cards
- Word Link Game
- Musical Memory
- Trivia Time
- BINGO
- *Bonus:* Visual Spark Cards

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Why This Kit Works For You & Your Residents

Designed for real Activity Directors who need meaningful engagement without hours of prep.

Recognition Over Recall

Residents are not put on the spot to “remember.” Instead, familiar themes, visuals, and prompts gently spark recognition, allowing participation without pressure.

Dignified & Adult-Centric

Every activity is designed for adults — not childish or overly simplified. The tone, topics, and visuals respect life experience and identity.

Multi-Sensory Engagement

This kit blends conversation, visuals, music, and group interaction to engage different cognitive pathways. Residents can participate in the way that feels most natural to them.

Adaptable for All Abilities

Activities can be used 1:1, in small groups, or larger settings. You can scale up or down depending on cognitive level, energy, and time available.

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How to Run This Session

No prep. No guesswork. Just follow the flow.

YOUR DONE-FOR-YOU SESSION FLOW · 45–60 MINUTES

1

WARM UP

Conversation Cards

5–10 minutes

Gently open the session with familiar, low-pressure prompts. Encourages comfort, participation, and initial connection.

2

ENGAGE

Visual Spark Cards

10–15 minutes

Use imagery to trigger recognition, storytelling, and memory. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals than direct questions.

3

CONNECT

BINGO or Trivia

15–20 minutes

Bring energy into the room with structured group interaction. Encourages laughter, participation, and shared experiences.

4

EMOTIONAL CLOSE

Musical Memory

10 minutes

End the session with music-based prompts or familiar songs. Creates emotional connection, calm, and a meaningful finish.

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What's Included in Your Kit

Everything you need to run multiple engaging sessions — without creating content from scratch.

6 ACTIVITIES · MULTIPLE SESSIONS · ZERO PREP

Conversation Cards
Thoughtfully written prompts that spark stories and memories. Works in group and one-on-one settings.

Visual Spark Cards
Image-based prompts that trigger recognition and emotional recall. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals.

Trivia Game
Curated questions based on familiar themes and shared cultural experiences. Encourages participation, not frustration.

Word Link Game
Engaging word association activity that stimulates cognition in a low-pressure way. Works across all ability levels.

BINGO Activity
A familiar game adapted with meaningful, recognizable themes. Encourages group interaction and energy.

Musical Memory
Song and lyric-based activities that tap into emotional memory. Perfect for connection and ending on a high note.

TOTAL VALUE

Multiple activities. Multiple sessions. Use this kit again and again without repeating the same experience.

"Designed to save you hours of planning — while delivering meaningful, dignified engagement."

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SECTION 1

CONVERSATION CARDS

CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & ENJOY

Saturday Night at the Movies

A-1

"What was the first movie you ever saw in a theater? Do you remember the smell of the popcorn and who sat beside you?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-2

"Drive-in movies were a whole experience — the speaker hooked on the car window, blankets in the back seat. What do you remember most about a night at the drive-in?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-3

"Did you have a favorite movie star you just had to see every picture they made? Who was it, and what drew you to them?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

What's on TV Tonight?

B-1

"The whole family gathered around one television set. What show did your household watch together, and did anyone fight over the channel dial?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-2

"TV dinners on a folding tray — what was your favorite part of eating supper in front of the television?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-3

"Do you remember watching the moon landing on television? Where were you sitting, and what did the room feel like?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

The Sounds of Our Lives

C-1

"Did you ever buy a 45 record just for one song? What was the first record you owned, and where did you play it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-2

"Whether it was a jukebox at the diner, a transistor radio at the beach, or a hi-fi in the living room — where did you do most of your listening?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-3

"Did you ever go to a live concert or a dance? What do you remember about the energy in the room?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Around the Neighborhood

D-1

"What did your neighborhood sound like on a summer evening? Screen doors slamming, kids playing, the ice cream truck bell?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-2

"The soda fountain or malt shop was the place to be. What was your go-to order, and who did you usually meet there?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-3

"Did your family have a favorite Sunday routine — church, a big dinner, a leisurely drive? What made Sundays feel different?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Style & Trends We Loved

E-1

"What was the fashion you were most proud to wear? Poodle skirts, bell-bottoms, saddle shoes — what was YOUR look?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-2

"Did you or someone you know spend serious time on their hair? Rollers, beehives, pompadours — what hairstyle takes you right back?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-3

"Was there a fad you couldn't resist? Hula hoops, mood rings, pet rocks — what was the silliest craze you got swept up in?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 2

VISUAL SPARK CARDS

IMAGE-BASED CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & SHARE

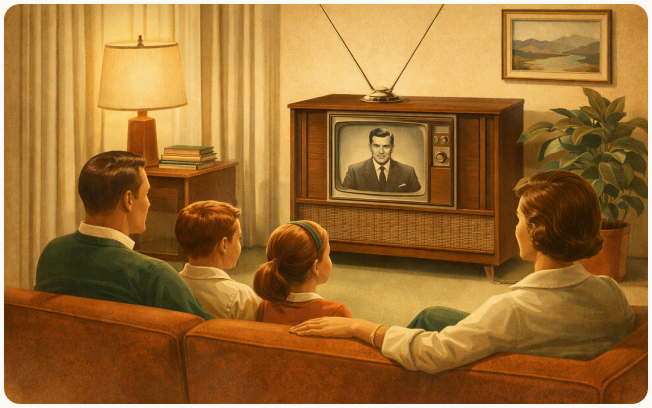
SPARK 1

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 2

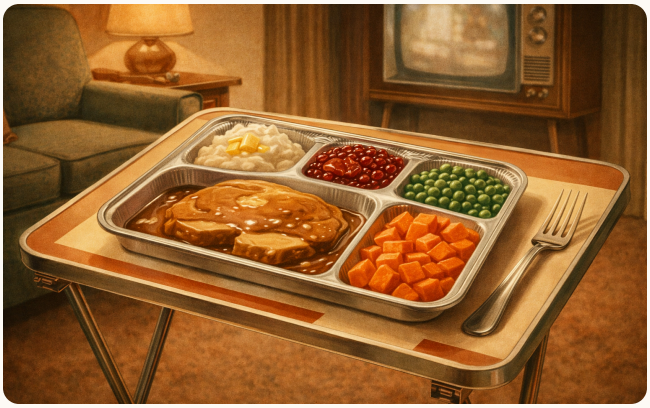
✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 3



✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 4



✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 5

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 6

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 7

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 8

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 9

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 10

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 3

TRIVIA TIME

20 QUESTIONS — POP CULTURE & DAILY LIFE ACROSS FOUR DECADES

The Silver Screen (Questions 1–5)

1. In The Wizard of Oz, Dorothy clicks her ruby slippers and says, "There's no place like ___."
   Answer: Home

2. What 1975 movie about a great white shark made everyone afraid to go swimming?
   Answer: Jaws

3. James Dean became a legend after starring in Rebel Without a ___ in 1955.
   Answer: Cause (Rebel Without a Cause)

4. What classic film features the line, "Here's looking at you, kid"?
   Answer: Casablanca

5. In the 1977 blockbuster, Luke Skywalker battles the evil Darth Vader. Name that film.
   Answer: Star Wars

The TV Room (Questions 6–10)

6. On I Love Lucy, Lucy was always scheming to get into Ricky's nightclub ___. What word completes it?
   Answer: Show (nightclub show)

7. What long-running western featured Marshal Matt Dillon keeping order in Dodge City?
   Answer: Gunsmoke

8. "The Fonz" was the coolest character on which 1970s sitcom?
   Answer: Happy Days

9. In 1964, which British rock band made their legendary American debut on The Ed Sullivan Show?
   Answer: The Beatles

10. What evening soap opera had the whole country asking "Who shot J.R.?" in 1980?

Answer: Dallas

Everyday Life (Questions 11–15)

11. Before cell phones, you'd step into a ___ booth to make a call away from home.

Answer: Phone / Telephone booth

12. S&H Green Stamps were collected at the grocery store. What could you redeem full books of stamps for?

Answer: Merchandise / household goods from the catalog

13. What popular frozen juice came in a small cardboard cylinder you mixed with water in a pitcher?

Answer: Minute Maid (frozen concentrate)

14. The milkman delivered right to your doorstep. What kind of bottles did the milk come in?

Answer: Glass bottles

15. What handheld device from the 1970s replaced the slide rule for doing math?

Answer: The pocket calculator

Music & Dance (Questions 16–20)

16. Elvis Presley was nicknamed "The King" of what type of music?

Answer: Rock and Roll

17. "The Twist" was a massive dance craze in the early 1960s. Who recorded the hit song?

Answer: Chubby Checker

18. The Woodstock music festival in the summer of 1969 took place in what U.S. state?

Answer: New York

19. What British singer, known as the "Rocket Man," was famous for wild costumes and oversized glasses?

Answer: Elton John

20. The "Disco era" is most closely tied to which decade?

Answer: The 1970s

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SECTION 4

WORD LINK GAME

FIND THE BRIDGE WORD

Read the two outside words aloud. Residents find the single "bridge word" that fits in the blank to complete a familiar compound word or phrase on BOTH sides.

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
1	DRIVE	_____	DOOR
2	BAND	_____	STILL
3	RECORD	_____	PIANO
4	NEWS	_____	ROUTE
5	DOOR	_____	HOP
6	POP	_____	FLAKE
7	GOLD	_____	BOWL
8	BASE	_____	PARK
9	BOOK	_____	HOLE
10	SUN	_____	POT
11	HOUSE	_____	SHOP
12	QUARTER	_____	STAGE
13	RAIN	_____	OUT
14	NIGHT	_____	TAIN

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
15	**MOON**	_____	**HOUSE**

Answer Key

1. IN
2. STAND
3. PLAYER
4. PAPER
5. BELL
6. CORN
7. FISH
8. BALL
9. WORM
10. FLOWER
11. WORK
12. BACK
13. DROP
14. CAP
15. LIGHT

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The Nostalgia Kit BINGO

Mark each square as it's called · Five in a row wins!

B	I	N	G	O
Mood Ring	Hula Hoop	Record Player	Station Wagon	Polaroid Camera
Roller Skates	TV Dinner	S&H Green Stamps	Soda Fountain	Muscle Car
Rotary Phone	8-Track Tape	FREE SPACE	Jukebox	Bell-Bottoms
Typewriter	Saddle Shoes	Moon Landing	Poodle Skirt	Glass Milk Bottles
Drive-In Movie	Transistor Radio	Disco Ball	Lava Lamp	Sock Hop

Print one copy per resident · Use coins, buttons, or markers to cover squares

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BINGO Facilitation Guide

BONUS ENGAGEMENT PROMPTS · FOR THE FACILITATOR ONLY

When someone calls “Jukebox”

Who had a favorite song they always played on the jukebox? What was it, and did you have a regular spot where you'd drop in a nickel to hear it?

When someone calls “Rotary Phone”

Do you remember your very first phone number? Did your family share a party line with the neighbors — and did anyone ever eavesdrop?

When someone calls “Station Wagon”

Did your family have a station wagon? Who got stuck in the way-back seat, and what was the longest road trip you ever took in one?

When someone calls “Sock Hop”

Did you ever go to a sock hop at school? What songs got everyone on the floor, and did you have a favorite dance partner?

When someone calls “Polaroid Camera”

Do you remember the magic of watching that Polaroid picture slowly appear? What's a moment you wish you'd captured on one?

When someone calls “Moon Landing”

July 20, 1969 — the whole world watched. Were you glued to the television? Do you remember how your family reacted?

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SECTION 6

MUSICAL MEMORY

Part A: Finish the Lyric

Read the artist name and the beginning of the lyric. Residents complete the missing word or phrase.

Bill Haley & His Comets (1954)

Rock Around the Clock

"One, two, three o'clock, four o'clock ___"

Answer: Rock

The Temptations (1964)

My Girl

"I've got sunshine on a cloudy ___"

Answer: Day

Aretha Franklin (1967)

Respect

"R-E-S-P-E-C-T, find out what it means to ___"

Answer: Me

The Beatles (1970)

Let It Be

"When I find myself in times of trouble, Mother Mary comes to ___"

Answer: Me

Gloria Gaynor (1978)

I Will Survive

"At first I was afraid, I was ___"

Answer: Petrified

Journey (1981)

Don't Stop Believin'

“Just a small-town girl, livin' in a lonely ___”

Answer: World

Part B: Who Made This Song Famous?

Read the clue about the song. Residents name the artist who made it famous.

B-1

“This artist was called "The King of Rock and Roll" and famously sang about a "Hound Dog" and a "Jailhouse.”

Answer: Elvis Presley

B-2

“This legendary singer, the "Queen of Soul," demanded R-E-S-P-E-C-T in her most iconic hit.”

Answer: Aretha Franklin

B-3

“These four lads from Liverpool started a "British Invasion" and wanted to "Hold Your Hand."”

Answer: The Beatles

B-4

“This "Material Girl" burst onto the scene in the 1980s and became one of the biggest pop stars in the world.”

Answer: Madonna

B-5

“This singer-songwriter asked the world to "Imagine" a place with no borders and lived in New York City with his artist wife.”

Answer: John Lennon

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